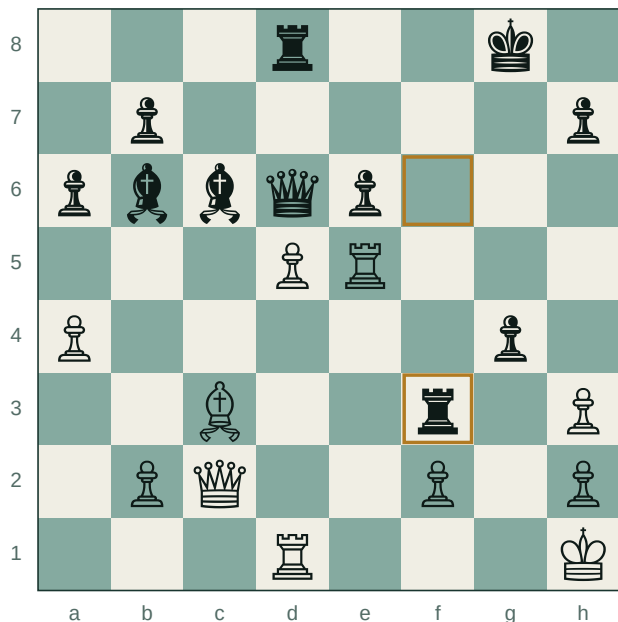


Deflection tactics: White, move 27

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 26...Rxf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Rg5+ Kf8 28. Qxh7 Qxh2+ 29. Kxh2 Rxh3+ 30. Qxh3

27.Rg5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **27...Kf8**.

28.Qxh7 The queen captures the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **28...Qxh2+**.

29.Kxh2 The king captures the queen on h2. Recorded reply: **29...Rxh3+**.

30.Qxh3 The queen captures the rook on h3.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +13. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +13:** the balance goes from -2 to +11. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b6. Check for tactical protection.